

PATTERN

Easy Crochet Crop Top Pattern (Beginner, Adjustable Fit)

A simple two-panel crop top built in double crochet rows — sized to your own gauge swatch, not a fixed chart.

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This top is two matching rectangles — front and back — worked in double crochet rows, then seamed at the sides and shoulders with gaps left open for the arms and neck. Rather than following a fixed size chart, every measurement is calculated from your own gauge swatch, so it fits regardless of your yarn or tension.

What you need

- DK or worsted weight yarn, roughly 300–400g depending on your size
- 4.0–5.0mm hook to match your gauge
- Yarn needle, measuring tape, stitch markers

Before you start: swatch and measure

Steps

1. Crochet a small swatch (about 12×12 sts in dc) in your chosen yarn and hook, then measure how many stitches and rows make up 10cm (4in) — this is your gauge.
2. Measure your chest at its fullest point, then decide your desired finished width per panel: (chest measurement ÷ 2) + 2–3cm ease.
3. Multiply your desired panel width by your stitch gauge (stitches per cm) to get your starting chain length, rounded to an even number.

Step 1: make two rectangle panels

Steps

1. Chain the length calculated above, plus 3 turning chains.
2. Row 1: dc in the 4th chain from the hook and each chain across.
3. Rows 2 onward: chain 3 (counts as the first dc), turn, dc in each stitch across.
4. Repeat until the panel measures your desired crop length, measured from underarm to hem on yourself or a well-fitting top.
5. Make a second, identical panel.

Step 2: seam the sides and shoulders

Steps

1. Lay the two panels together, right sides facing.
2. Seam up each side from the hem, leaving the top 15–18cm open on both sides for the armholes.

3. At the top edge, seam a few centimetres in from each outer corner toward the center, leaving a gap open in the middle for the neck — test the opening against your head before fully closing it.

Step 3: finishing edges

Work one round of single crochet around the neckline, both armholes, and the hem to neaten the raw edges and add a small amount of stretch-resistance.

Frequently asked questions

What if my gauge swatch doesn't match exactly?

That's expected and fine — the whole pattern is built from your own gauge, not a fixed chart, so as long as you measure your swatch honestly the math will still fit.

Can I add straps instead of full shoulder panels?

Yes, a halter or tie-strap version can be made by narrowing the top few rows of each panel into straps instead of seaming a full shoulder — a slightly more advanced adjustment.

What stitch works instead of plain double crochet?

Half double crochet gives a denser, less gappy fabric if you prefer more coverage.

Written by Emily Hartwell

Emily has been crocheting for over a decade, ever since her grandmother taught her the basics one summer. She started CrochetGuides to write the clear, honest, beginner-friendly instructions she wishes she'd had when she was learning — the ones that actually work the first time.